

Select the correct answer from the codes given below.

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

The Cabinet Mission of 1946 AD came to India to discuss the transfer of power from the British Government to the Indian Leadership, with the aim of preserving India's unity and granting it independence formulated at the initiative of Clement Attlee, the Prime Minister of United Kingdom, the mission included Lord Pethick-Lawrence, the secretary of state for India, Sir Stafford Cripps, President of the Board of Trade and A.V. Alexander, the first Lord of the Admiralty. Lord Wavell, the Viceroy of India, did not participate in every step but was present. The Mission arrived on March 24, 1946 AD.

According to the Mission, the representation of the Provincial Legislatures were to be broken up into 3 sections

- (a) Section A : Madras, United Provinces, Central Province and Berar, Bombay, Bihar & Orissa.
- (b) Section B : Punjab, Sindh, NWFP
- (c) Section C : Assam and Bengal.

Apart from this, the Provinces of Chief Commissioners, Delhi, Ajmer-Marwar and Coorg will be included in category (A) and Baluchistan will be included in category (B).

The Congress accepted the proposals related to the constituent assembly. But since, the Muslim league had been given disproportionate representation; it rejected the idea of the interim government.

The Muslim League first approved the Plan. But when congress, declared that it could change the scheme through majority in the Constituent Assembly they rejected the plan. Muslim League on repeated request by Lord Wavell joined the Interim Government on 13 October, 1946 AD.

19. Which one of the following leaders of the Congress was totally in favour of Cabinet Mission Plan?

- (a) Mahatma Gandhi
- (b) Jawaharlal Nehru
- (c) Sardar Patel
- (d) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2001

I.A.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

The opinions of the topmost Congress leaders of the time bear ample testimony to the fact that the Cabinet Plan was not devoid of reality. Mahatma Gandhi was totally in favour of the the Cabinet Mission Plan. According to Gandhiji, "It is the best document the British Government could have produced in the circumstances."

20. Which Congress President negotiated with both Cripps Mission and Lord Wavell?

- (a) Abul Kalam Azad
- (b) Jawaharlal Nehru
- (c) J.B. Kriplani
- (d) C. Rajagopalachari

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

Abul Kalam Azad negotiated with both Cripps Mission and Lord Wavell. He presided over Congress from 1940 AD to 1946 AD.

21. Who was the President of Indian National Congress during the visit of Cabinet Mission to India?

- (a) Jawaharlal Nehru
- (b) J.B. Kripalani
- (c) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
- (d) Sarojini Naidu

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

Ans. (c)

Maulana Abul Kalam Azad was the President of Congress during the arrival of the Cabinet Mission to India. He was authorised by Congress Working Committee for discussions with Mission. He negotiated with the members of the Cabinet Mission on 6 April, 1946 AD.

Constituent Assembly (1946)

*The very first idea of Constituent Assembly was enshrined in Swaraj Bill of 1895, which was prepared under Bal Gangadhar Tilak's directions. In the 20th century, Gandhiji firstly pointed towards this idea when in the year 1922 AD he said that the Indian Constitution should be made as per India's need. Motilal Nehru, in 1924 AD, demanded the formation of Constituent Assembly. After this M.N. Roy officially proposed this demand and the basic concepts of Constituent Assembly was prepared by **Jawahar Lal Nehru**. Congress in Faizpur Session (December 1936 AD) defined the idea of the Constituent Assembly and also pointed out its importance. Constituent Assembly was formed on the recommendation of the **Cabinet Mission Plan**.

*On 24 March, 1946 AD, Cabinet Mission arrived at Delhi. During the announcement of this mission, its President, Pethick Lawrence made it clear that the aim of this mission was to prepare a plan for the formation of Constituent Assembly to make a constitution of free India and to make proper arrangements of an interim government for the Indians. *As per the Cabinet Mission plan, for the formation of Constituent Assembly each provinces were given the number of seats in the proportion of one seat for every **Ten lakh** of the population. Three voter groups were made - General, Muslims and Sikhs (Only in Punjab). *Elections for the **296** seats of the Constituent Assembly were held in provinces in July 1946 AD. *In the constituent Assembly, 208 Congress members were elected, **73**

Muslim League candidates were winners and 15 others were elected. *Md. Ali Jinnah was not a member of Constituent Assembly. The first meeting of Constituent Assembly was held on **9 December, 1946 AD**. **Dr. Sachchidananda Sinha** was its first provisional president. *On **11th December, 1946 AD**, its second meeting was held at Delhi and **Dr. Rajendra Prasad** was elected as its Permanent President. *Indian Constitution was adopted on **26th November, 1949 AD**. At the time of its formation, the Constituent Assembly was not a sovereign institution. *On **14th August, 1947 AD**, Constituent Assembly was declared as a sovereign body of the Indian Union with Dr. Rajendra Prasad as its President. ***G.V. Mavlankar** held the posts of Speaker of Central Legislative Assembly and the speaker of Indian Parliament. He was the speaker of Central Legislative Assembly from 24 January 1946 AD to 14th August, 1947 AD and became the first speaker of Lok Sabha after India's Independence. He was the Speaker of Lok Sabha from 1952 to 1956. He was the Speaker of Bombay Legislative Assembly from the year 1937 AD to 1946 AD.

1. Which one of the following first mooted the idea of a Constituent Assembly to frame a Constitution for India?

- (a) Swaraj Party in 1935
- (b) Congress Party in 1936
- (c) Muslims League in 1942
- (d) All Parties Conference in 1946

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

The idea of the Constitution of India was seen in 'Swaraj Bill' of 1895 for the first time but officially it was stated in the Faizpur Congress Session in 1936 AD. In this session, the constituent Assembly was vastly explained. It is notable that if option (a) would be Swaraj Party, 1934 then it would be the correct answer. The Swaraj Party demanded the development of Constituent Assembly in Ranchi (1934 AD).

2. The Constituent Assembly that framed India's constitution was set up –

- (a) Under the Indian Independence Act
- (b) Under the Government of India Act, 1935
- (c) By the Queen's Proclamation
- (d) Under the Cabinet Mission Plan

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (d)

Constituent Assembly was founded under Cabinet Mission. The President of Cabinet Mission declared that the main purpose of this mission was to make a Constitution Committee for Constitutional reforms in India. According to the Proposals of the Cabinet Mission, the assembly of the constituent assembly will be constituted by the representatives of the legislative assembly of provinces, the chief commissioners and the representatives of the princely states.

3. Which one of the following gave the idea of Constituent Assembly for India?

- (a) Simon Commission
- (b) Rajaji Formula
- (c) Cabinet Mission Plan
- (d) Wavell Plan

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. Under the Cabinet Mission Plan, the total number of seats allotted to each province in the Constituent Assembly was roughly in the ratio of one representative to the population of –

- (a) 8 lakh persons
- (b) 10 lakh persons
- (c) 11 lakh persons
- (d) 12 lakh persons

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2002

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

Under the Cabinet Mission, the total number of seats allocated to each province in the Constituent Assembly was roughly in the ratio of one representative to the population of 10 lakh persons on a communal basis. Three classes of voters were accepted –

(1) General (2) Muslims (3) Sikhs (only in Punjab).

5. The first session of the Constituent Assembly was held on :

- (a) 16th August, 1947
- (b) 26th January, 1948
- (c) 9th December, 1946
- (d) 26th November, 1946

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (c)

The first meeting of the Constituent Assembly was held on 9th December, 1946 AD. After two days, Rajendra Prasad was elected as the permanent President of the Constituent Assembly on 11 December, 1946 AD.

6. Who among the following was the President of the Indian Constituent Assembly?

- (a) Dr. Rajendra Prasad
- (b) Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru
- (c) Sardar Patel
- (d) Dr. B. R. Ambedkar

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (a)

Dr. Rajendra Prasad was the permanent President of the Indian Constituent Assembly. Dr. B. R. Ambedkar was President of the Drafting Committee. Jawaharlal Nehru was President of Union Power Committee, Union Constitution Committee etc. Vallabhbhai Patel was President of Advisory Committee on Fundamental Rights, Minorities, Tribal and excluded areas.

7. The first President of the Sovereign Constituent Assembly for the Dominion of India was –

- (a) C. Rajagopalachari